Give the model a brief, not a request.

A request leaves the model to guess. A brief gives it the five parts of context it needs to do the job well. Leave one out and it fills the gap with a guess.

T. R. A. M. P.

T	**Tools** What can it use?	The tools and access it has: search, files, apps, connections. Check what it can reach before you ask. No wording fixes a missing tool.
R	**Roles** Who does what, and who decides?	Its role and yours. “You draft, I decide.” Reviewer, analyst, skeptic: say which.
A	**Acceptance criteria** What does good look like?	Length, format, audience, tone, and how you will judge it done.
M	**Materials** What should it read or look at?	The exact documents, data and examples. Hand them over instead of hoping it finds them.
P	**Process** What order, what steps?	The steps and the checkpoints. “Ask me questions first.” “Outline before you draft.”

The same ask, twice

A customer has emailed asking for a refund on an order from six weeks ago.

A request

“Write a reply to this customer.”

Everything else is a guess: the facts, the tone, the length, and who sends it.

A brief

- **T** You can look up her order in our order system.
- **R** You draft the reply; I’ll edit and send it.
- **A** Under 150 words, warm but firm, one concrete fix, no blame.
- **M** Use her email and our returns policy, both attached.
- **P** First check her order date against our return window. Tell me if she qualifies, then draft.

Weak answer? Don’t reword it. Find the missing letter.

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